

Why do human beings need religion?

↳ Because they want answers to questions:

1. Purpose of Mankind's Existence

2. How did everything come into existence, and why does it exist at all?

↳ Humans look to following for answers:

1. Science:

↳ Provides evidence of how
↳ Can't Explain why

2. Philosophy:

↳ Explores human purpose but varies across thinkers
↳ Lacks absolute truth

3. Religion:

↳ Provides spiritual, moral and intellectual guidance.

In Islam, the need for religion is deeply rooted in human nature (fitrah) and the purpose of existence. Islam teaches that human beings are created by Allah with a natural inclination to seek Him and the truth. Religion provides guidance, purpose, and a moral framework for life. Below are some key reasons why human beings need religion from an Islamic perspective:

Defining Religion:

↳ A particular system of belief in God or Gods and activities that are connected with this system. (Collins Dictionary)

↳ The belief in and worship of a God or gods, or any such system of belief and worship. (Cambridge Dictionary)

↳ Divine guidance for mankind which was first inspired by the Allah Almighty in human nature and after that it was given by Him with all essential details to mankind through His prophet (S.W.S). (Islam)

Origin of Religion

↳ Auguste Comte, a French philosopher and sociologist, proposed the **three laws of stages**, which describes the intellectual evolution of mankind.

1. Theological stage:

↳ Here, human thought is dominated by religious and supernatural explanations

↳ People attribute natural phenomena to gods, spirits or divine being.

↳ Storms, diseases are seen as will of deities

Example,

↳ People believed fire to be god

↳ People believed that lightning was caused by Zeus.

2. Metaphysical stage:

↳ Transitional phase b/w theological and positive stage.

↳ People began to replace supernatural explanations with abstract concepts and philosophical reasoning.

↳ Attribute events to be caused by unseen forces or universal laws based on speculation rather than evidence.

3. Positive/Logical stage:

↳ Human thought is based on scientific reasoning

↳ Knowledge acquired through experiments & facts.

↳ Comte believed that "all knowledge that is factual is connected with experiences, in such a way that verification or direct or indirect confirmation is possible." This means that true knowledge must be observable, measurable, and subject to verification through experimentation or empirical evidence. If something cannot be tested or observed, it does not count as valid knowledge in the scientific sense.

Theories of origin of religion:

- **Physical Sciences - Law of Nature (Newton)**
 - Sir Isaac Newton formulated the Laws of Motion and Universal Gravitation, explaining that the physical world operates based on predictable, measurable principles. These laws apply regardless of human beliefs or perceptions.
- **Sociological Theory - Religion as a Product of Social Necessities (Emile Durkheim)**
 - Émile Durkheim, a founding sociologist, viewed religion as a social construct that serves the needs of society. Religious beliefs and rituals help unify individuals, create moral order, and maintain stability within communities.
- **Psychological Theory - Religion as a Fulfillment of Psychological Needs (Sigmund Freud)**
 - Sigmund Freud, the father of psychoanalysis, saw religion as a psychological coping mechanism.
 - He argued that religious beliefs arise from deep-seated human fears and desires, particularly the fear of death and the unknown.
 - Religion provides helps people deal with anxiety and existential uncertainty .
- **Historical Theory - Religion and Class Struggle (Karl Marx)**
 - Karl Marx viewed religion as a tool used by the ruling class to control the oppressed.
 - He famously called religion "the opium of the people," meaning it numbs people to their suffering and prevents them from seeking real social change.
- **Theological Theory - Religion as Part of Human Nature**
 - In Islam, the need for religion is deeply rooted in human nature (fitrah) and the purpose of existence. Islam teaches that human beings are created by Allah with a natural inclination to seek Him and the truth